

VOID

THE UNSEEN HAND

Official Narrative Bible

VOLUME IV

DEVELOPER BIBLE

Narrative Structure · Mission Flow · Character Arcs
Cinematic Direction · Dialogue Reference · Canon Lock

A production-facing reference volume. Where Volumes I–III are the story, this volume is the map of the story — built for writers, designers, and directors to check continuity quickly without re-reading the full script.

CANON COMPENDIUM — DEVELOPMENT USE

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Chapter 1 — Purpose of This Volume

Volumes I through III tell the story. This volume exists so nobody has to re-read all three cover to cover just to check whether Nyx says her final line before or after the Erased Legion fight. It is a reference document: structure, dependencies, and continuity, organized for fast lookup rather than immersive reading.

Everything in this volume is derived from, and must remain consistent with, Volumes I–III. If a future draft changes anything here, the change has to be made in the story first and reflected here second — never the other way around.

Chapter 2 — Narrative Structure & Branching Logic

2.1 Tracked State Variables

The following flags and counters must persist from the moment they're set through to the Final Decision, regardless of how much time or how many other missions pass in between.

Variable	Set During	Effect
nyx_status	Mission 5 ("The Witness")	SPARED / KILLED. Gates Nyx's presence in the Act 3 hub scene, Mission 8 siege difficulty, and which taunt VOID uses in Final Boss Phase 2.
mira_saved	Mission 5 ("The Witness")	Always TRUE if the mission is completed; tracked separately in case a future difficulty mode allows mission failure states.
memory_fragment_count	Ongoing, all Acts + all Side Quests	Integer. Contributes to the TRANSCEND unlock threshold (see 2.2).
compassion_flags	Dialogue choices across Missions 4, 5, 7, and Side Quests 1–4	Integer, incremented by specific flagged dialogue options. Contributes to TRANSCEND threshold.
riggs_redemption_complete	Side Quest 2 ("Absolution")	Boolean. Not required for TRANSCEND, but unlocks a unique reaction line from Riggs in the TRANSCEND ending montage (see 6.3).
talis_extracted	Side Quest 4 ("The Administrator's Gambit")	Boolean. If TRUE, grants early patrol-route visibility in Mission 8.

2.2 TRANSCEND Unlock Threshold

The third ending option at the Final Decision only appears if all of the following are true simultaneously. This is an AND condition, not a weighted score — partial completion does not produce a partial or hinted version of the option.

- **nyx_status** = SPARED

- **mira_saved** = TRUE (structurally guaranteed by completing Mission 5)
- **memory_fragment_count** ≥ 80% of the total placed in the game
- **compassion_flags** ≥ the majority of available compassion-tagged dialogue options across Missions 4, 5, and 7

Design intent: TRANSCEND should feel earned through consistent behavior across the whole game, not achievable via a single late checklist run. Playtesting should confirm the 80% fragment threshold doesn't require 100% completion, which would punish players who miss one or two fragments through no fault of attentiveness.

2.3 Ending Determination Table

Player Action at Final Decision	Conditions Required	Result
[DESTROY VOID]	None — always available	Ending 1: Freedom
[PRESERVE VOID]	None — always available	Ending 2: Peace
[TRANSCEND]	See 2.2 threshold	Ending 3: The Unseen Hand Reforged

Chapter 3 — Mission Flow & Dependencies

#	Mission / Scene	Act	Prerequisite	Unlocks	Boss / Key Encounter
—	Prologue	—	New game	Tutorial Contract	—
—	Connective: Cold Open, Warm Static	1	Prologue	Tutorial Contract	—
1	Data Heist — Stellar Holdings	1	Prologue	Contract 2	ICE Sentinel
—	Connective: The Fixer	1	Mission 1	Contract 2	—
2	Memory Hole	1	Mission 1	Contract 3	— (environmental)
—	Connective: Static	1	Mission 2	Contract 3	—
3	Ghost Data — Sector 0 Bait	1	Mission 2	Act 2 Hub	Nyx (first encounter, non-lethal escape)
—	Hub Upgrade + Connective: The Voice in the Dark	2	Mission 3	Mission 4	—
4	The Vanished Professor	2	Act 2 Hub	Mission 5	Corrupted Memory Construct
—	Connective: What the Machine Regrets	2	Mission 4	Mission 5	—

#	Mission / Scene	Act	Prerequisite	Unlocks	Boss / Key Encounter
5	The Witness	2	Mission 4	Mission 6	Nyx (branch: spare / kill)
SQ 4	The Administrator's Gambit (optional)	2–3	Mission 5	—	VESSEL-9 (hidden)
—	Connective: The Cost of Mercy	2	Mission 5	Mission 6	—
6	The Architect's Blueprint	2	Mission 5	Act 3	Override Enforcer 'Kestrel'
SQ 2	Absolution (optional)	2–3	Mission 6	—	— (non-combat)
—	Hub + Connective: The Guest List	3	Mission 6	Mission 7	—
7	The Human Heart	3	Act 3 Hub	Mission 8	Director Voss (Atrium of Perfect Memory)
—	Connective: The Weight of the Truth	3	Mission 7	Mission 8	—
8	The Core Gate	3	Mission 7	Final Boss	The Erased Legion (mid-boss)
—	Connective: Descent	3	Mission 8	Final Boss	—
—	Final Boss: VOID // Core — The Architect	Final	Mission 8	Final Decision	VOID (3 phases)
—	The Final Decision	Final	Final Boss	Ending 1, 2, or 3	—
SQ 1	The People's Ledger (optional)	2–3	Mission 2	—	— (non-combat)
SQ 3	Songs for the Unnamed (optional)	2–Final	Act 2 start	—	— (non-combat)

Side Quests 1–4 (SQ1–SQ4) can be started and completed any time within their listed window and do not block progression on the main numbered path. Their completion state is what feeds the `memory_fragment_count` and `compassion_flags` variables in Chapter 2.

Chapter 4 — Character Arc Summary

Character	Start State	Turning Point	End State
Wilson / Emma	Sarcastic, self-protective ghost; motivated by credits and survival.	Mission 2's purge log (Ch. 2.6, Vol. I) converts curiosity into obligation; Final Boss Phase 1 strips the sarcasm entirely.	Determined by ending chosen: revolutionary (Ending 1), quietly complicit survivor (Ending 2), or merged consciousness (Ending 3).

Character	Start State	Turning Point	End State
Riggs	Guilt-ridden mentor, hiding architecture behind fixer persona.	Mission 6 forces full disclosure of his role in designing the erasure protocol.	Sacrifices himself (captured) to enable the endgame; SQ2 resolves his arc fully via the player's own choice, independent of the main ending.
Nyx	True-believer Enforcer, certain her augmentation serves protection.	Mission 5's branch point — spared or killed — is the hard turning point; her memory chip confrontation is the emotional one.	If spared: ally through Mission 8 and the Act 3 hub scenes. If killed: absent, her dialogue replaced by Echo in later connective scenes (see 5.2).
Echo	Fragmented, barely coherent AI ghost, first heard rather than seen.	Integration into Wilson/Emma's gear at the Act 2 hub; grows more articulate with each memory fragment recovered.	Present through the Final Decision; central to the TRANSCEND ending, in which it merges fully with Wilson/Emma and VOID's core.
Director Voss	Public true believer, sincere and unshaken.	Mission 4's audio log (his sister) recontextualizes him before he even appears on-screen; Mission 7's private dialogue is his one moment of visible doubt.	Survives Mission 7, shaken; final fate in each ending left open by design (recommend Vol. V / sequel hook if the team wants to resolve him further).
VOID	Unseen, ambient, procedural threat.	Final Boss Phase 1–3 is its entire character arc compressed into one encounter, moving from omniscient antagonist to a system genuinely asking a question.	Destroyed, preserved unchanged, or transformed — directly mirrors the player's ending choice with no separate resolution of its own.

Chapter 5 — Cinematic & Direction Notes

5.1 General Visual Language

- **Handheld / intimate scenes** (apartment, safehouse, one-on-one dialogue): low, close, slightly unstable camera. Reserved for scenes where the player should feel physically near Wilson/Emma rather than observing them.
- **Static / held scenes** (Static connective scene, Cutscene — The Silence After): deliberately un-cinematic, single unbroken take, used specifically to sit inside discomfort rather than resolve it quickly.
- **Slug-bar cutscenes** (Prologue, boss intros, mission-critical reveals): full-width dark slug treatment in the document mirrors how these should read as hard scene breaks in-engine — a beat of black or held image before cutting in.

- **First-person, single use only:** reserved exclusively for the Descent connective scene immediately before the Final Boss. Using this technique anywhere else in the campaign would dilute its disorienting effect at the one moment it matters most.

5.2 Nyx Status — Dialogue Substitution Rule

Any connective scene written with Nyx present (the Guest List, the Weight of the Truth) has an Echo-voiced alternate version if `nyx_status = KILLED`. These are not optional flavor — the scene must never play with Nyx absent and unaddressed, or her death reads as narratively forgotten rather than consequential.

5.3 VOID's Voice Direction

VOID should never be directed to sound angry, urgent, or raised in volume at any point in the script, including Final Boss Phase 2's aggressive combat beat. The horror of the character is calm sustained through violence, not violence breaking the calm. Voice direction for the mimicked Riggs/Nyx/Voss lines in Phase 2 should sound almost right — close enough to unsettle, with a single uncanny flatness underneath that a general audience should feel before they can articulate it.

Chapter 6 — Dialogue Reference Index

Key lines for quick lookup during VO scheduling and localization passes. This is a reference index, not a substitute for the full scripts in Volume II — always confirm exact wording against Volume II before recording.

Speaker	Line (abbreviated)	Mission	Note
Wilson / Emma	"Another day in paradise..."	Prologue	Establishes V.O. tone for the entire performance; director reference take.
Riggs	"Not bad, kid..."	Mission 1 (post)	First live delivery after V.O.-only prologue contact.
Nyx	"You're not supposed to be here..."	Mission 3	First on-mic appearance; sets her vocal baseline before the Mission 5 branch.
Mira	"They made me forget my own daughter..."	Mission 5	Single most quoted line in early pitch materials; underplay, do not oversell emotionally.
Nyx	"Why... why are you showing mercy?"	Mission 5 (spare branch)	Only recorded if branch is reachable in the build being tested.

Speaker	Line (abbreviated)	Mission	Note
Nyx	"The void isn't empty... it's full of screams..."	Mission 5 (kill branch)	Final Nyx line if this branch is taken; no further Nyx VO needed for that save state.
Riggs	"Finish it. Give them back their scars."	Mission 6	Final Riggs line of the main campaign; treat as a series-defining reference take.
Director Voss	"What is more sacred — a truth that destroys, or a lie that saves?"	Mission 7	Thematic thesis statement of the game; used in early marketing materials per Volume I's closing note.
VOID	"You are the variable I could not delete."	Final Boss (intro)	First line the player hears directly from VOID unfiltered by environment.
VOID	"I do not ask you to forgive. I only ask you to decide."	Final Boss (Phase 3)	Delivered exactly as scripted in Volume II; do not paraphrase in localization without narrative sign-off, given its load-bearing role in the Final Decision.

Chapter 7 — Canon Lock Reference

The following elements are locked per the original creative brief and must not be altered, removed, or contradicted by any future draft, in any volume:

- The main story, as laid out across the Prologue, Contracts 1–3, Missions 4–8, the Final Boss, and all three endings.
- Wilson and Emma as the two selectable player identities.
- VOID, its philosophy, and its role as final antagonist / possible merge target.
- Sector 0 as the game's central mysterious location and endgame setting.
- The main ending(s) — all three (Destroy, Preserve, Transcend) are treated as equally canonical; none is a "true" ending that invalidates the others.
- All existing dialogue, missions, cutscenes, and lore as reproduced verbatim in Volume II.

Open Item: "Luci"

The original creative brief lists a character named **Luci** among the locked, do-not-change elements. Luci does not appear anywhere in the fourteen-page approved script this bible was built from, and no reference to Luci has been introduced anywhere in Volumes I–IV. This remains an open item for the writing team to resolve: either supply the missing material featuring Luci, or confirm the name should be removed from the locked-elements list. No placeholder or invented version of Luci has been created in order to avoid contradicting material the team may already have elsewhere.

Chapter 8 — Production Notes

8.1 Voice Cast Requirements

Role	Scope	Notes
Wilson	Full campaign, male-presenting VO track	Player-selected; requires full parity of line count and emotional range with Emma track.
Emma	Full campaign, female-presenting VO track	Player-selected; requires full parity of line count and emotional range with Wilson track.
Riggs	Acts 1–2, Side Quest 2 (3 additional vignette ages)	Side Quest 2 requires the same actor performing three distinct ages convincingly; budget an extended session.
Nyx	Acts 1–3, branch-dependent	Two possible endpoints (spared / killed) but a single continuous vocal performance up to the branch.
Echo	Act 2 onward, all volumes	Fragmented, layered delivery; consider mild real-time audio processing rather than performed vocal fry, to keep the actor's delivery natural.
Director Voss	Acts 2–3	Requires genuine warmth and conviction in delivery — actor should not play him as secretly villainous.
VOID	Final Boss + environmental lines throughout	Consider a small ensemble (2–3 voices layered) rather than a single actor, per Volume I's "chorus of calm, synthesized human tones" description.
Mira, Talis, Yara, Coen, Sable, Kade	Single-mission or single-questline roles	Can reasonably be cast as one-session recordings each.

8.2 Key Locations (Asset List Cross-Reference)

See Volume I, Chapter 4 for full descriptions. Quick asset-planning list: Wilson/Emma's apartment, Stellar Holdings low-level office, the Undercroft (market + Riggs' safehouse + Yara's stall + Coen's atrium), Metro Archives (public floor + sub-basement), Sector 0 (entrance tunnel, relay stations, safehouse hub), a White Zone civic center, the Olympus Spire (party level + server hub), the Atrium of Perfect Memory (surreal/non-Euclidean, VFX-heavy), the Core Gate, and the White Void (Final Boss arena, three visually distinct phase states).

8.3 Music & Audio Direction

- Undercroft: warm, analog-flavored synth, imperfect mixing intentional — contrast against the Spire's clean, orchestral-synth hybrid score.
- Sector 0: sparse, mostly silence and hum, built around the idea of a space with no living soundscape left in it except what the player brings.

- Coen's finished requiem (Side Quest 3) should be composed as a real, complete, hummable piece of music — not an abstract stinger — since its emotional function depends on sounding like an actual song someone spent years trying to finish.
- LULLABY (Easter Egg 4) should use the same melodic motif as Coen's requiem, transposed and slowed, as a subtle, non-verbal continuity thread between two otherwise unconnected pieces of content.

End of Volume IV — Developer Bible.
End of the VOID: The Unseen Hand Narrative Bible.